

CT CHURCH CORE VALUES

INTRO: We have spent a lot of time and effort in the last year or so communicating the CT vision with everyone connected to CT Church.

Can everyone say [the CT vision](#) with me?

- [Disciple...](#)
- [Empower...](#)
- [Serve...](#)

Disciple – We understand that in order to disciple a person we must first lead them to Christ. (4 steps of discipleship) Disciple = I have led someone to Christ – I have trained that person – They have led someone to Christ – They are training their convert. Only then is the process of discipleship complete.

Empower – We are going to empower you

through knowledge – That is what this teaching is about – We are going to attempt to empower you with the Holy Spirit. Acts 1:8 ***“You shall receive power...”***

Serve – Serve God through worship – Serve in a ministry in the church – Serve the community through outreach – Serve the world through missions.

Having a vision statement and communicating that statement to everyone connected to the church is only the first step to a healthy, vibrant, effective organization that reaches it’s potential and God given dreams.

The second step is to get everyone to embrace and live by a set of core vales. [CT Church has a list of six core values](#) that has been communicated and drilled into the staff and board. Over the next few weeks I want to roll out these core values in an attempt to

get every single person connected to CT church to embrace and enact these values in everything we do for this church and in our personal lives.

I. BIBLICAL INTEGRITY – “*Do it with the right heart.*”

2 Timothy 4:1-5 (NKJV) “*I charge you therefore before God and the Lord Jesus Christ, who will judge the living and the dead at His appearing and His kingdom: 2 Preach the word! Be ready in season and out of season. Convince, rebuke, exhort, with all longsuffering and teaching. 3 For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine, but according to their own desires, because they have itching ears, they will heap up for themselves teachers; 4 and they will turn their ears away from the truth, and be turned aside to fables. 5 But you be watchful in all things, endure afflictions, do the work of an evangelist, fulfill your*

ministry.”

Paul knew that after his death, his understudy, Timothy, was going to face the temptation to go off the tracks theologically.

Paul’s concern was that the culture would slowly, but surely; cause Timothy to depart from sound Biblical teaching. It is an absolute fact that the culture is a constant pull on church leaders. The church was intended to create the culture rather than being affected by the culture. Rather than allowing the culture to dictate what the church can and cannot preach, **the church must embrace a philosophy of relevance without compromise:**

- The church cannot ignore shifts in the culture...
- The church must adapt its methods to attract the culture...
- The church must NEVER allow the culture to change the message we

preach...

Some of the way's we have accomplished this at CT Church:

- We have gone outward rather than inward... (The culture does not feel the need to go to church as other cultures have – So we must go to them)
- We moved discipleship from Sunday morning to Wednesday night... (The culture stopped attending Sunday School at 9:45 on Sunday morning but would attend on Wednesday night)
- We stopped having Sunday night services and started having life groups... (We were having 100-150 attendees on Sunday night – We now have more than 400 attending life groups)

We have done all this, and it has been VERY effective, yet, we have not compromised the message we preach or the doctrine we believe.

How do we assure Biblical Integrity at CT church?

- We are not open to changing our doctrine for anyone...
- We demand to know what each teacher and life group leader is teaching...
- Everything preached and taught in this church must line up with the doctrine we espouse...

Biblical Integrity has much to do with preaching and teaching sound doctrine but it is also much more. Biblical integrity has much to do with making sure that with all our doing, we “Do it with the right heart.” Ecclesiastes 9:10 (NKJV) ***“Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work or device or knowledge or wisdom in the grave where you are going.”***

To be completely true to our core value of Biblical Integrity we must make sure that we

do everything:

- For the right reason... Motives must constantly be examined. This Scripture is all about motive
- With the right passion... We must be passionate about everything we do. Every person must work with passion every time – ***“Do it with your might.”***
- With a sense of urgency... Every chance we have for ministry should be approached with a sense of urgency – ***“Ministry cannot be accomplished in the grave that you are going to.”***

In an effort to fulfill this CT Core Value each of us must stay in the lane of being true to our doctrine and working with a sense of urgency! Say it with me... **Biblical Integrity** – ***“Do it for the right reason.”***

II. RIDICULOUS STEWARDSHIP –
“Do it in the right way.”

Steward – “*A person who manages another's property or financial affairs; one who administers anything as the agent of another or others.*” (dictionary.com)

Stewardship – “*The responsible overseeing and protection of something considered worth caring for and preserving.*” (dictionary.com)

When the leadership of CT Church was walking through the process of developing our Core Values we decided that stewardship should be at or near the top of our list. Not only did we believe that we should espouse stewardship but we should practice and demand Ridiculous Stewardship. It is one thing to be a steward but it is a totally different thing to practice it in a ridiculous manner.

We are told in the Word that our Christian duty is to be faithful as a steward. 1

Corinthians 4:1-5 (NKJV) *“Let a man so consider us, as servants of Christ and stewards of the mysteries of God.*

2 Moreover it is required in stewards that one be found faithful. 3 But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged by you or by a human court.[a] In fact, I do not even judge myself. 4 For I know of nothing against myself, yet I am not justified by this; but He who judges me is the Lord. 5 Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord comes, who will both bring to light the hidden things of darkness and reveal the counsels of the hearts. Then each one’s praise will come from God.” Paul lays out the case for

stewardship to the Corinthian Church:

As followers of Christ we are *“Stewards of the mysteries of God.”* – We are not just another social organization, we are the church and as such we are the ones who possess the answers to all the world’s problems! Therefore, we should not just

practice stewardship we should practice
Ridiculous Stewardship!

Stewards are “***REQUIRED to be found FAITHFUL.***”

- Required = Greek – Zhtew (Zay-tay-O)
– An affinity to seek to plot about a desire or endeavor. This means that we are going to be held accountable for the assignment we have been given in the Kingdom. We have already established that we are all stewards – this is not just another assignment – this is a Kingdom assignment and we are “***REQUIRED***” to do it right!
- Faithful = Greek – Pistoij (Pis-tos’) – To be objectively and subjectively trustworthy. In other words we are to be the kinds of stewards that do not need much oversight to perform our responsibilities. But when oversight comes we continue performing at an extremely high level rather than resisting

the oversight!

In the context of CT Church what areas are we required to exercise Ridiculous Stewardship?

- Prayer... Don't just pray – Live in an attitude of prayer! ***“Praying always, with all prayer and supplication...”***
- The Word... Don't just read your Bible study it! ***“Study to show yourself approved...”***
- Relationships... Don't just show yourself friendly – Be extremely friendly! ***“He that has friends must show himself friendly...”*** Host or attend a life group.
- Serving... Each CT'er should have a ministry to the Lord (worship), a ministry within the church (Where are you serving?), a ministry to the community (What outreach are you involved in?), and a ministry to the world! (Be a missions supporter – Give

& Go!) “*Whatever your hand finds to do...*”

- **Caring for assets...** Part of stewardship is taking great care of what you already have. If we cannot take care of what we already have, why would God want to give us more? Treat all CT assets better than you would treat your own – Take ownership not proprietorship – Pick up trash etc – Never say, “*It’s not my job!*” Practice the golden rule - “***Do unto others (Stuff) as you would have them to do unto your (Stuff)...***” If you want to borrow something, notify the proper people... Bring it back... Bring it back in at least as good condition as you received it...
- **Giving...** If you are going to work in the union, you have to pay union dues – If you are going to be involved at CT Church we EXPECT your minimum financial commitment to be 10% of your gross family income! When you tithe the

devourer is rebuked! When you give above your tithe you are enacting the spirit of multiplication! Do you want addition or multiplication in your finances? Are you going to be a steward or practice Ridiculous Stewardship? Four things we EXPECT you to do financially – Tithe (10% of your gross family income) – Give to missions monthly – Participate in H4H – Participate in Harvest Sunday) ***“The generous person shall be made fat...”***
“The person who hoards tends to poverty... The person who scatters (Gives) will be given a harvest.”

You may say, *“This is a ridiculous expectation”* and you would be right! **Our Core Value is Ridiculous Stewardship!**

Here at CT we are going to practice Ridiculous Stewardship – We are committed to *“Do it the right way!”*

III. ABSOLUTE DEPENDABILITY –

“Do it at the right time”

Matthew 16:24-26 (NKJV) *“Then Jesus said to His disciples, “If anyone desires to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow Me. 25 For whoever desires to save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for My sake will find it. 26 For what profit is it to a man if he gains the whole world, and loses his own soul? Or what will a man give in exchange for his soul? “*

(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Absolute = Free from restriction or limitation; not limited in any way
- Dependability = Capable of being depended on; worthy of trust; reliable
(dictionary.com)

In light of the words of Jesus and the definitions of *“Absolute dependability”* this

core value is making the statement that we are all agreeing, that we can be counted on, to do what we have committed to do, when we committed to do it – NO MATTER WHAT!

I think that somewhere along the way, we have missed what is absolute about our faith and replaced it with what is acceptable. We are settling for a Christianity that revolves around catering to ourselves when the central message of Christianity is actually about abandoning ourselves.

We are not talking here just about dependability – we are talking about Absolute Dependability! We are not talking about a 50/50 chance that we are going to do what we have committed to – we are saying there is a 110% chance we can be depended on to do what we said we would do!

Each of us who consider ourselves to be Dependable people should ask two important and introspective questions: **(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- When we agree to take care of a task or lead a ministry, can our superiors check the assignment off their to do list?
- When we have committed to a task, do our leaders constantly feel the need to check to see if it is being done, and what progress is being made?

If we want to be Absolutely Dependable we should do the following when our leader makes an assignment: **(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Send something in writing confirming the assignment... (Preferably an email or text – This should include who is going to do what, by when)
- Ask for written confirmation of the assignment and its parameters...

(Preferably email or text – If this doesn't happen – The conversation never happened)

- Send regular, unsolicited, progress reports... (Text – email – etc)
- Always communicate with the leader (unsolicited) when the assignment has been completed...

As a leader I have learned its not so much what you expect as it is what you inspect – I learned this by working with undependable people!

Absolute Dependability: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Is doing what I committed to do before the deadline has evaporated... (If we agreed to do it we should see it through – Some people give their leaders whiplash from all their quick starts and sudden stops)

- Is being where I'm supposed to be... (If we are going to be Absolutely Dependable we should ALWAYS be at our post of duty and NEVER make anyone invest time and effort in tracking us down)
- Is showing up on time... (On time for a leader is being late – Arrive early – Tardiness is a bad habit)
- Is handling as many details as possible without needing constant supervision... (If the leader has to get it all together – they do not need us – They might as well do it themselves!)
- Is never failing to show up... (This is not an option for an Absolutely Dependable leader)
- Is answering ALL of our calls, texts, and emails in a timely fashion... (4 hour rule – Some people won't answer a call but will respond to a text immediately – This is very frustrating to leaders)

- Is training my own replacement...
(Always check with the leader before starting this process – There may be a reason certain people are not ready to be promoted - Sometimes leadership has more to do with a handoff than a hail marry)

An Absolutely Dependable person is one who realizes that they are in this world for God's purpose and not their own.

In Luke nine:

- Jesus sent the twelve out...
- He fed five thousand...
- Peter declared Jesus to be the Son of God...
- Jesus was transfigured on the Mt. of Olives...
- A demon-possessed boy was delivered...

The crowd had witnessed all of this and three separate people immediately responded by volunteering to follow Jesus. Look at His response to their offers:

- I will follow you but I don't want to leave my house... ***“Foxes have holes and birds have nests but the Son of God has no place to lay His head.”***
- I will follow you but I first need to bury my father... ***“Let the dead bury the dead.”***
- I will follow you but I must arrange my business affairs... ***“No one having put his hand to the plough and looks back if fit for the Kingdom”***

As far as we can tell from this scripture, Jesus talked these guys out of following him. This gives us a picture of ourselves: **Many of us want the benefit of Christ without the associated sacrifice!** Absolutely

Dependable people are sometimes called upon to sacrifice without benefit! (In such cases God is keeping a record and will find a way to get it back to you!)

IV. SELFLESS TEAMWORK – “*Do it together*”

1 Corinthians 3:1-10 (NKJV) *“And I, brethren, could not speak to you as to spiritual people but as to carnal, as to babes in Christ. 2 I fed you with milk and not with solid food; for until now you were not able to receive it, and even now you are still not able; 3 for you are still carnal. For where there are envy, strife, and divisions among you, are you not carnal and behaving like mere men? 4 For when one says, “I am of Paul,” and another, “I am of Apollos,” are you not carnal? 5 Who then is Paul, and who is Apollos, but ministers through whom you believed, as the Lord gave to each one? 6 I planted, Apollos watered, but God gave the increase. 7 So*

then neither he who plants is anything, nor he who waters, but God who gives the increase. 8 Now he who plants and he who waters are one, and each one will receive his own reward according to his own labor. 9 For we are God's fellow workers; you are God's field, you are God's building. 10 According to the grace of God which was given to me, as a wise master builder I have laid the foundation, and another builds on it. But let each one take heed how he builds on it."

In verse five Paul speaks about what it takes to put together a successful team. He says that neither he nor Apollos are of any consequence without the help of God and others!

No one can build a church alone. It takes a team to fulfill God's vision because he has appointed a destiny in the house that is bigger than any one member. This church

will never fulfill its mission without Selfless Teamwork, doing the work of God together!

If I might refer to Paul and Apollos in this way, they were really coaches who were attempting to build a team, called a church.

We understand that **we will not be successful without the help of the Lord but the truth is, even if the Lord helps us, He will require us to work harmoniously with a host of other people.**

When it comes to the church, the Pastor is really the coach who is attempting to make the church successful to the mandate that God has given it. (Angel of the church – Deacon who said, “*God did not speak to me about hiring this music director.*” – The Pastor is the visionary) Paul says, 1 Corinthians 3: 6-8 (NKJV) “**I planted, Apollos watered, but God gave the increase.**” So then neither he who plants is

anything, nor he who waters, but God who gives the increase.⁸ Now he who plants and he who waters are one, and each one will receive his own reward according to his own labor.”

While it is true that we will all be rewarded for the effort we have invested in the Kingdom we must realize **we are not the team; we are individual team members.**

No team can be successful if its individual players are not committed to its purpose. Making a commitment to a team does not guarantee smooth sailing. We tend to get on the nerves of one another.

We live in a world where people are not very committed in their personal lives. The lack of commitment in our society has carried over into our work for the Lord.

Have you ever witnessed a team winning a national championship whose team members showed up to practice sessions when they felt like it? What team would allow it's players to miss one or two games out of three? If we are committed to Selfless Teamwork and we are going to do it together.

The church will never be successful in its purpose without committed team members who will: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Attend church on a faithful basis...
- Commit to a ministry...
- Tithe whether things are going well or not... (Joshua & Achan)
- Be faithful even in difficult seasons...

What kind of team members are we going to be? If we are uncommitted or constantly jumping from team to team, we will never know the joy of being a part of a successful

team! (Do you think church-hoppers ever wonder if the problem may have come with them?)

Michael Jordan may be the greatest player that ever played the game of Basketball. Can you imagine how far he could have gone as a one-man team?

Joe Montana may very well be the greatest quarterback ever to hold a football in his hands, but can you imagine how successful he would have been without receivers and an offensive line? 1 Corinthians 3:7-8

(NKJV) ***“So then neither he who plants is anything, nor he who waters, but God who gives the increase.”*** Here Paul lets us know in no uncertain terms that **our personal success is not nearly as important as the success of God’s plan.**

When we work with Selfless Teamwork as one of our core values, if we are being

double-teamed, we have the opportunity to pass the ball to a team member! We must guard against being a ball hog and grandstanding. It is not about us, [it is about the success of the assignment we have been given](#). We are committed to Selfless Teamwork and doing what we do together.

A few years ago, Tennessee was the number one team in the nation. In Knoxville, the Arkansas Razorbacks were leading and driving deep into Tennessee territory late in the fourth quarter. Clint Sterner, the Arkansas quarterback scrambled out of the pocket looking for an open receiver. He tripped and attempted to keep himself from going down by placing the football on the ground. He fumbled the ball and Tennessee recovered and drove for a touchdown and the victory. Many in the news media blamed Clint Sterner for the loss but at the press conference that followed, Houston Nutt, the coach of the Razorbacks focused on how

many tackles were missed; how many passes were dropped; how many blocks were not executed; he said *“As a team we failed to execute, therefore we lost a game that we should have won.”*

When a church fails to make good on its assignment it is never the fault of one person. Fault can be found from the pastor to the janitor and all points in between!

When we fail, we fail as a team.

Just as no church fails as a result of one person's mistakes, no church succeeds as a result of one person's ability. We live in a day where personal accomplishments are celebrated and rewarded but no one succeeds on their extraordinary ability alone! (Turtle on a stump)

Look at what Paul has to say; 1 Corinthians 3:8 (NKJV) “Now he who plants and he who waters are one.”

God spoke this to me recently; “*This church will never be stronger than its weakest leader!*” Because of this truth, I challenge every leader in this church to commit themselves to Selfless Teamwork and working together with others to do what we have been assigned to do.

We should never forget that *the ministry is not a sprint it is a relay race.* We are eternally connected to our predecessors and our successors! I am a link in a chain of human leadership!

If we want to be a part of a successful team we must: **(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Listen to our leaders...
- Be committed team members...

- Place the success of the group ahead of our individual stats...
- Mourn all failures as a group...
- Celebrate all successes as a group...

V. EXTREME EXCELLENCE – “*Do it well*”

Ecclesiastes 9:10 (NKJV) “*Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work or device or knowledge or wisdom in the grave where you are going.*”

This passage tells us several things:

- Make sure your hand finds something to do... We should all find something we can do and do it well. No free loaders or deadbeats allowed!
- Do it with your might... We are looking for passionate people who are tired of passivity. Passivity is the neutering of the church. For those committed to Extreme Excellence and doing it well, there is no place for passivity.

- Whatever we do, we should do it well...
We must feed the passion of ministry every day if we expect to maintain enough momentum to do things well.
- The day will come when we will not be able to do what we want... *“Work while it is day for the night is coming when no one can work.”*

In light of this, think through this core value:

- Extreme = Going to the utmost or very great lengths in action, habit, opinion, etc...
- Excellence = The fact or state of superiority or eminence...

(Dictionary.com)

Excuses are the enemy of Extreme Excellence and doing things well.

To be Extremely Excellent we must stop with the excuses for not *“Doing it (Whatever we have committed to do) well!”*

Excuses are the archenemy of Extreme Excellence! Excuses render the people with the best motives far less than Excellent! Lack of excellence is a momentum killer. Momentum is very difficult to create and a team member mailing it in erodes the momentum of the entire organization or group.

Momentum is very difficult to create and even more difficult to recreate. Making allowances for people who kill momentum with a halfhearted attitude is the death rattle of the organization.

In the story of the first opportunity for the Children of Israel to possess the Promised Land we soon discover the fatal sin of half-heartedness. The very reason for forty years spent wandering around in the wilderness is because of half-heartedness. Numbers 32:23 (NKJV) “...*Be sure your sin will find you out.*”

My mother used to scare me to death with this Scripture; I thought everything I had ever done would eventually come to light.

We all know there are many sins that a person commits which are never revealed. If we confess our sins while God is still dealing with us in mercy he covers them from public view and forgets them for eternity! If this is the case, what could this Scripture possibly mean?

This Scripture deals exclusively with the sin of half-heartedness. Half-heartedness is simply a failure to pour ones best effort into a thing. In spiritual terms, half-heartedness is a stubborn refusal to wholly follow God!

In this Scripture Moses is telling the tribes of Reuben and Gad that their sin was one of half-heartedness. They were requesting to stay on the other side of Jordan! Numbers

32:4-5 (NKJV) ***"The country which the Lord defeated before the congregation of Israel, is a land for livestock, and your servants have livestock. 5 Therefore they said, "If we have found favor in your sight, let this land be given to your servants as a possession. Do not take us over the Jordan."***

Moses is saying to these tribes of Israel that the sin of half-heartedness would cost them dearly. The sin of half-heartedness will always bring devastating consequences into the lives of those affected by it. A faith-filled life leaves no room for half-heartedness. Those who understand what is at stake in the kingdom of God demand Extreme Excellence and are willing to accept nothing less than doing things well!

God always judges the sin of half-heartedness:

- On the job...

- In the home...
- In all relationships...
- In the area of finances...
- In our spiritual walk with God...

Listen to the warning God gives Israel about their sin against Him. Numbers 14:29

(NKJV) ***“The carcasses of you who have complained against Me shall fall in this wilderness, all of you who were numbered, according to your entire number, from twenty years old and above.”***

Numbers 14:36-37 (NKJV) ***“Now the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the congregation complain against him by bringing a bad report of the land, 37 those very men who brought the evil report about the land, died by the plague before the Lord.”***

The sin of half-heartedness manifested itself at the Red Sea. At the first sign of danger

they were ready to go back to Egypt. When they arrived in Kadesh Barnea this malady was alive and well and because of it, they turned thumbs down on a golden opportunity to inherit the Promised Land. The fact that they did not believe they could conquer Canaan is astounding to me when they were already forty miles inside the land when they made such an asinine decision.

Three things will happen to those who refuse to practice Extreme Excellence and doing things well:

- They find themselves vulnerable to the over-powering on-slots of hell... The enemy amplifies half-heartedness and uses our lack of Extreme Excellence against us.
- They tend to approach their spiritual lives in the same way they approach kingdom tasks – in a halfhearted manner, and as a result their spiritual lives lose fervor day by day... A

halfhearted approach to our spiritual life renders us weak and anemic which causes us to be vulnerable to all kinds of attacks and temptations.

- Because of this, the presence of the Lord is lost and defeat is never far away...

Passive people tend to surrender early –
Passionate people tend to persevere no matter what! Who would we rather have on our team, passive or passionate people?

Rather than facing the challenges of Canaan by faith and a spirit of Excellence, these people made every excuse in the book and by an act of their own will, chose to dumb down their destiny.

No matter how wonderful they are, people who cling to excuses will never be Excellent:

- Making an excuse is an attempt to justify our right to fail...
#stopmakingstupidexcuses
- Excuses are poor substitutes for results...
#stopmakingstupidexcuses
- Quitters never win and winners never quit... #stopmakingstupidexcuses

The Extremely Excellent find a way - The passive find an excuse:

- God creates a way out of no way for the Extremely Excellent...
- Those who have a “*That’s good enough*” attitude create their own excuses rather than achieving results...
- Excuses are lies wrapped up in reasons...
- Excuses keep people in their comfort zone and prevent Extreme Excellence...

#stopmakingexcusesstupid

The Extremely Excellent should stop making excuses for people who have a constant excuse, and start holding them accountable to our core value of being Extremely Excellent: (Talk about group accountability)

- Stop saying "*They mean well*" and say, "*You need help*"...
- Stop saying "*He/she is a good person*" and say, "*You need to get your act together*"...
- Good people are Extremely Excellent...
- Bad people have a "*That's good enough*" attitude and constantly make excuses...

#stopmakingexcusesstupid

CONCLUSION:

As a team, if we eliminate excuses, failure has no leg to stand on!

The leadership team of CT Church has decided we will stand on the core value of Extreme Excellence and we will all do what we are supposed to do: *“Do it well!”*

We will also hold one another accountable for Extreme Excellence!

VI. RADICAL RESPECT – *“Do it with honor”*

1 Peter 2:11-19 (NKJV) *“Beloved, I beg you as sojourners and pilgrims, abstain from fleshly lusts which war against the soul, 12 having your conduct honorable among the Gentiles, that when they speak against you as evildoers, they may, by your good works which they observe, glorify God in the day of visitation. 13 Therefore submit yourselves to every ordinance of man for the Lord’s sake, whether to the king as supreme, 14 or to governors, as to those who are sent by him for the punishment of evildoers and for the praise of those who do*

good. 15 For this is the will of God, that by doing good you may put to silence the ignorance of foolish men— 16 as free, yet not using liberty as a cloak for vice, but as bondservants of God. 17 Honor all people. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honor the king. 18 Servants, be submissive to your masters with all fear, not only to the good and gentle, but also to the harsh. 19 For this is commendable, if because of conscience toward God one endures grief, suffering wrongfully. “

Our Core Value, Radical Respect, doing it with honor is an extremely important one. No organization can function properly or effectively without respect and honor.

Respect and honor are inextricably connected and cannot be separated.

179 times the Bible uses the word Honor or some form of it. Deuteronomy 5:16 (NKJV) (The 5th Commandment) “*Honor your*

father and your mother, as the Lord your God has commanded you, that your days may be long, and that it may be well with you in the land which the Lord your God is giving you.” (What I thought this Scripture meant when my parents used it)

- Radical = Thorough or extreme, especially as regards change from accepted or traditional forms.
- Respect = Esteem for a sense of worth or excellence.
- Honor = High regard for worth, merit or rank.

(Dictionary.com)

Radical Respect that results in Honor =
Extreme regard that results in proper honor
of the worth or rank of another.

When we say that we have Radical Respect
and that we will do all that we do with honor
this means that we will always ***“Prefer***

others ahead of ourselves.” That we will always be submitted to authority – Make sure we are in our lane – and never overstep, under-step, sidestep, overreach or under reach – We will be honoring in all of our decisions and actions!

As you can see, respect and honor go hand in hand. In the context of the local church, before we can decide how Radical Respect looks we must first understand [the Biblical order of how the Church should operate](#):

- [Jesus is the head of the Church...](#) Jesus gave His life to build the Church! He is the undisputed head of the Church.
- [The Pastor is the highest human authority in the Church...](#) When Jesus spoke to the seven churches of Revelation He spoke to “*The angel*” of each Church. The angel of the Church is the Pastor of the Church. When God gives vision to the Church He ALWAYS gives it to the Pastor of the Church.

- The staff of the Church serves at the will of the Pastor of the Church... The staff is in place not to have their own vision but to implement the vision of the Pastor.
- The Board of the Church is a function of the New Testament... Deacon = Servant.
- The Board of the Church is a function of the state... 501© 3 – In the case of CT Church – The Board of the Church is nominated by the Church body and screened for qualifications by the Board of the Church and then elected by the Church body.
- The members of the Church agree to be governed by a doctrinal and governmental structure... The members and key leaders agree to a doctrinal statement – They agree to a governmental structure (We cannot have each person doing what is right in their own eyes – That is anarchy).

The reason we have such a structure is because we know that God honors structure, Respect and Honor. (Everyone must have someone they are accountable to – Absolute power absolutely corrupts)

In the Bible verses I read to you we are told to have:

- Respect for God... In verse 13 –
“Submit yourself to every ordinance of man” – Verse 15 *“This is the will of God”*
- Respect for others... In verses 13 and 14 – *“To the king supreme”* – *“To the Governor”* – *“To those sent by them”*
- Respect for the work of God... Verse 17
“Love the brotherhood”
- Respect for ourselves... Verse 12
“Having your conduct honorable among the Gentiles, that when they speak against you as evildoers, they may, by your good works which they

- observe, glorify God in the day of visitation”*
- Respect for things... Verse 12 *“Having your conduct honorable among the Gentiles, that when they speak against you as evildoers, they may, by your good works which they observe, glorify God in the day of visitation”*
 - Respect for masters... Verse 18 *“Servants, be submissive to your masters with all fear, not only to the good and gentle, but also to the harsh”*
 - Respect for servants... Verse 17 *“Honor all men”*

One cannot really do a study on Radical Respect without also considering two things.
(1) Servant-hood (2) Alignment

SERVANTHOOD:

Matthew 8:5-10 (NKJV) *“Now when Jesus had entered Capernaum, a centurion came to Him, pleading with Him, ⁶ saying, “Lord,*

my servant is lying at home paralyzed, dreadfully tormented.”⁷ And Jesus said to him, “I will come and heal him.”⁸ The centurion answered and said, “Lord, I am not worthy that You should come under my roof. But only speak a word, and my servant will be healed.”⁹ For I also am a man under authority, having soldiers under me. And I say to this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes; and to another, ‘Come,’ and he comes; and to my servant, ‘Do this,’ and he does it.”¹⁰ When Jesus heard it, He marveled, and said to those who followed, “Assuredly, I say to you, I have not found such great faith, not even in Israel!”

In this passage of scripture, we have one of the greatest lessons of Radical Respect and Honor that you will find in the Bible or anywhere else.

The centurion was a man of great influence and when he approached Jesus, his request

was not for himself but for his servant.

“Now when Jesus had entered Capernaum, a centurion came to Him, pleading with Him, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant is lying at home paralyzed, dreadfully tormented.”

Servant leadership is always about others; it is never about us.

We should ask ourselves the following questions to determine whether our service is really producing Radical Respect:

- Are we serving to make ourselves feel good or to benefit someone else?
- Are we serving because we love these people or because God loves them? If we serve honorable with Radical Respect we will find ourselves needing to serve people that we have a hard time loving.
- Are we serving to be seen of man or of God?
- Are we serving for a temporal or eternal reward?

Because of Radical Respect, the centurion placed his life on hold and laid aside his very important responsibilities to pursue Jesus on behalf of his servant.

Radical Respect demands that when we are going to serve in an area, we should do so as a 100%'er! **What does 100% look like?**

- Serve when we feel like it...
- Serve when we don't feel like it...
- Be where we are supposed to be when we are supposed to be there...
- Serve with a good attitude... (If you serve and then complain, you might as well not have served at all)

A person committed to serving with Radical Respect always adds value to the team. This kind of leadership does not always add value to the one offering the sacrificial service, but the team is always better because of it.

The centurion put himself out there because of Radical Respect for his servant. This man took a risk to add value to someone beneath him:

- He risked his other responsibilities going undone...
- He risked Jesus rejecting his request for help...
- He risked raising the expectation level of the servant with the possibility of no results...

People who serve with Radical Respect:

- Understand the value they add... (They understand they are not the team; they add value to the team)
- Focus on bringing harmony and health to the team...
- Know how to stand up and they know how to stand down...

ALIGNMENT:

The centurion understood the value of alignment. ***“Lord, I am not worthy that You should come under my roof. But only speak a word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority...”*** The centurion seemed to understand three things here that I find to be profound:

- He understood that it was not the touch of Jesus that was bringing the miracles about; it was the word of Jesus...
- He realized that Jesus was not doing these things on His own, but was doing them as the result of a much higher authority... ***“I also am a man under authority.”***
- He understood that when a person comes under authority, they have the support of those above them... If we refuse to come under authority we will NEVER have the full support of those above us and therefore cannot be in authority!

The centurion valued the power of being in alignment. Think with me about alignment:

- Your car needs alignment periodically...
- If the spine is out of alignment, nothing else works right...
- To have a line means someone is in the front and someone is in the back - alignment must occur between those two points...

Those who serve with Radical Respect and Honor always:

- Stay in alignment...
- Follow protocols...
- Do not over-step...
- Do not under-step...
- Do not side-step...

CONCLUSION:

Jesus recognized the centurion to be a man of incredible honor who was serving with Radical Respect and He healed the servant

as a result! Great results occur when servant leaders commit to follow a visionary leader with Radical Respect and Honor.

Notice the words of Jesus with regard to the centurion. ***“Assuredly, I say to you, I have not found such great faith, not even in Israel!”*** We should not overlook the fact that Jesus calls the actions of a servant leader, ***“Faith.”***

Servant-hood and alignment releases a greater sense of health, authority and productivity into the overall vision. It also has a profound positive impact on the life of the person operating in Radical Respect, and doing it with Honor.